

Classical Magnetic Systems

On the behaviour of macroscopic magnetized moments in dissipative
environments

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Preface

This document contains our work regarding the novel spin revolution effect, first described by PD Dr. Elena Vedmedenko and Prof. Roland Wiesendanger[**Vedmedenko**]. The goal of this project is to further the understanding of the presented systems by investigating certain mathematical aspects of the system's description. Our hope is to procure either analytically solvable equations of motions or prove that such solutions do, in fact, not exist. We start by introducing the necessary mathematical principles rooted in the theory of manifolds, variational calculus and ordinary differential equations. From there on, we investigate various realizations of the spin revolution effect.

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CHAPTER ONE

Mathematical Introduction

We start with the necessary mathematical theory. If the reader already feels comfortable with the theory of smooth manifolds, variational calculus on aforementioned spaces, (Lie) groups as well as autonomous differential equations, they may skip this chapter. We assume basic knowledge of linear algebra and calculus.

1.1 Group Theory

We need some fundamental group theory. From here on, all vector spaces are finite-dimensional.

Definition 1.1 (Group). A **Group** is a pair $(G, \circ)$ consisting of a set G and an operation $\circ$ such that the following axioms are satisfied:

$$\forall a, b, c \in G : a \circ (b \circ c) = (a \circ b) \circ c$$

- $\forall a \in G \exists a^{-1} \in G : a \circ a^{-1} = 1$
- $\exists e \in G \forall a \in G : e \circ a = a$

If the operation is commutative, we call the group **abelian**.

One should think of groups in terms of symmetries: A symmetry of an abstract object can be thought of as a collection of operations leaving said object invariant.

There are plenty of examples of groups important in physics:

Example 1.2. Let V be a real vector space. The automorphisms $V \rightarrow V$ constitute a group under composition, the *general linear group* of dimension n , $GL_n(V)$. There are several important subgroups of $GL(\mathbb{R}^n)$ we will heavily use later. Let

$$\langle \cdot, \cdot \rangle : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

be the euclidean scalar product on $\mathbb{R}^n$ and $T \in GL(\mathbb{R}^n)$. We define the *orthogonal group* as

$$O(n) := \{Q \in GL(\mathbb{R}^n) \mid QQ^t = Q^T Q = \text{id}\} \leq GL(\mathbb{R}^n).$$

Further restricting our attention to orthogonal automorphisms with unit determinant yields the *special orthogonal group*

$$SO(n) := \{R \in O(n) \mid \det R = 1\} \leq O(n)..$$

In physics, we are usually concerned with how a certain group acts on a physical system. For that, we need actions and representations.

Note that every vector space over $\mathbb{R}$ has a basis. Choosing one and representing automorphisms as $n \times n$ -matrices yields the usual group structure by matrix multiplication. This also clearly demonstrates that groups of linear maps cannot be abelian in general.

Definition 1.3 (Group Action). Let G be a group with identity e and M be a set. A **right-action** of G on M is a map

$$\alpha : G \times X \rightarrow X.$$

such that:

- $\alpha(e, x) = x$
- $\alpha(h, \alpha(g, x)) = \alpha(gh, x)$

is satisfied. We write $G \curvearrowright M$ and $\alpha(g, x) =: g.x$ for short.

Definition 1.4 (Representation). Let V be a real vector space and G be a group. A **real G -representation** is a group homomorphism

$$\rho : G \rightarrow \text{GL}(V).$$

We call V **representation space** and $\deg V$ the degree of the representation.

Apart from that, we will need the notion of an algebra, which equips vector spaces with additional structure.

Again, we do not demand commutativity. In contrast to groups, we do not demand associativity nor the existence of an identity either. Hence, associative resp. commutative algebras are explicitly denoted. An algebra with identity is called **unital**.

Definition 1.5 (Algebra). An **$\mathbb{R}$ -algebra** is a pair $(V, [\cdot, \cdot])$ where V is a real vector space and

$$[\cdot, \cdot] : V \times V \rightarrow V$$

is a *bilinear operation*, i.e. for all $u, v, w \in V$ and all $\lambda, \mu \in \mathbb{R}$ the following holds:

- Left distributivity: $[(u + v), w] = [u, w] + [v, w]$
- Right distributivity: $[u, (v + w)] = [u, v] + [u, w]$
- Scalar Compatibility: $[\lambda v, \mu w] = (\lambda \mu)[v, w]$.

While this may seem abstract at first, there are plenty of important examples in physics.

Example 1.6. We start with some easy examples from physics. The first algebra encountered in physics is probably the vector space $\mathbb{R}^3$ with the vector cross product $\times$. This is also a non-commutative, non-associative, non-unital algebra, which in turn satisfies the *Jacobi identity*

$$(u \times (v \times w)) + (v \times (w \times u)) + (w \times (u \times v)) = 0.$$

Example 1.7. In maths, the first example is usually the division algebra of the complex field $\mathbb{C}$ with multiplication of complex numbers. It is commutative, associative and unital. The term *division algebra* arises from the fact that multiplicative inverses but no zero divisors exist. Higher-dimensional variants of the complex numbers are still algebras, but less well-behaved ones. The *quaternions* $\mathbb{H}$ are still an associative and unital division algebra, but not commutative. The octonions $\mathbb{O}$ also lose associativity.

1.2 Differential Geometry

Smooth Manifolds and Tangent Spaces

From now on, we use the Einstein summation convention.

Definition 1.8 (Topological Manifold). A **topological n -manifold** is a topological space M such that:

- M has the Hausdorff property.
- M is second-countable.
- M is locally euclidean: For every $p \in M$ there is an open neighbourhood $U \subseteq M$ of p and a homeomorphism $\phi : U \rightarrow V$ such that $V \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is open. We call (ϕ, U) a **chart** on M .

Since we want to apply the formalism in concrete examples, we will often work in local coordinates. Note that with the standard basis of $\mathbb{R}^n$, we can write a chart map as

$$\phi(p) = (\phi_1(p), \dots, \phi_n(p)) =: (x^1(p), \dots, x^n(p)).$$

where $x^i : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are the chart components. Since the charts are homeomorphisms, they can be locally inverted to a map $\phi^{-1} : V \rightarrow U$, in which case we call ϕ^{-1} a *local parametrization* of M .

Example 1.9. • Trivially, the real euclidean space $\mathbb{R}^n$ is an n -dimensional smooth manifold with the identity id being a global chart.

- The n -sphere $\mathbb{S}^n$ is a smooth manifold with local charts given by projection onto the coordinate axes.
- The n -torus

$$T^n = \underbrace{\mathbb{S} \times \dots \times \mathbb{S}}_{n \text{ times}}$$

is a smooth n -manifold. In the case of T^2 , one obtains local charts easily as the 2-torus is a surface of revolution.

We need the notion of smoothness on manifolds.

Definition 1.10 (Smooth Manifold). A **maximal atlas** for a topological manifold M is a collection $\mathfrak{A}$ of charts of M such that every $p \in M$ is contained in some chart and $\mathfrak{A}$ is not properly contained in some other atlas. We call $\mathfrak{A}$ smooth if for any two charts $(U, \phi), (V, \psi) \in \mathfrak{A}$ we have either $U \cap V = \emptyset$ or

$$\phi^{-1} \circ \psi : V \rightarrow U.$$

is a smooth ($\mathcal{C}^\infty$) map, called **chart transition map**. A **smooth manifold** is a pair $(M, \mathfrak{A})$ such that M is a topological manifold and $\mathfrak{A}$ is a maximal smooth atlas.

Note that with this, we get a notion of smooth maps on abstract manifolds: If M, N are smooth manifolds and $F : M \rightarrow N$ is a map, we call it smooth if for every $p \in M$ there is a chart (U, ϕ) with $p \in U$ and a smooth chart (V, ψ) with $F(p) \in V$ such that

$$\psi \circ F \circ \phi^{-1} : \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$$

is smooth in the usual sense.

There are many examples important to physics:

Example 1.11. • The $\mathbb{R}^n$ obtains a smooth maximal atlas by means of the identity.

- The sphere $\mathbb{S}^2$ has a smooth atlas with two charts $\mathbb{S}^2 \setminus N$ and $\mathbb{S}^2 \setminus S$, where N and S are north and south pole, respectively. The chart map is given by the *stereographic projection* $\sigma : \mathbb{S}^2 \setminus N \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$.
- Any finite-dimensional real normed vector space V is a smooth manifold. The choice of a basis determines an isomorphism $\mathbb{R}^n \cong V$ which we take as global chart. For any other basis, one obtains a basis transformation matrix which is linear, hence a $\mathcal{C}^\infty$ chart transition.
- Any open subset $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is a smooth manifold on its own with the smooth atlas $\{U, \text{id}_U\}$. We call such a manifold an *open submanifold* of $\mathbb{R}^n$.

With smooth maps on manifolds, we are already able to talk about curves or paths on such spaces. However, in physics one is especially interested in velocity and acceleration. For this, we will need two additional structures: The tangent bundle, which comes naturally with every smooth manifold, and a metric to measure distances and angles. We define a **curve** on a manifold M to be a smooth map

$$\gamma : I \rightarrow M$$

where $I \subseteq \mathbb{R}$ is some interval.

Definition 1.12 (Tangent Bundle). Let M be a smooth manifold and $p \in M$. We declare two smooth curves $\gamma_i : I \rightarrow M$, $i \in \{1, 2\}$ to be equivalent if for any chart (U, ϕ) of p we have

$$\left. \frac{d}{dt}(\phi \circ \gamma_1) \right|_{t=0} = \left. \frac{d}{dt}(\phi \circ \gamma_2) \right|_{t=0}. \quad (1.1)$$

The space of equivalence classes of such curves is called **tangent space** at p and denoted $T_p M$. The **tangent bundle** of M is the disjoint union

$$TM := \coprod_{p \in M} T_p M.$$

Note that while the tangent space at a point on an n -manifold is an n -dimensional real vector space (and hence isomorphic to a copy of $\mathbb{R}^n$), the tangent bundle is a $2n$ -dimensional space and indeed also a smooth manifold. However, it is not always possible to identify $TM \cong M \times \mathbb{R}^n$. A point in TM is a pair (p, v) , where $p \in M$ and $v \in T_p M$. We also have a natural projection $\pi : TM \rightarrow M$, given by $\pi(p, v) = p$.

Tangent vectors act on smooth functions $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by

$$v(f) = \left. \frac{d}{dt} \right|_{t=0} (f \circ \gamma)(t).$$

Note that this gives rise to the usual partial derivative of a function $g : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by setting

$$\left. \frac{\partial g}{\partial x^i} \right|_y := \frac{d}{dt} g(y + te_i).$$

where γ represents one path with $\dot{\gamma}|_{t=0} = v$. Using the fact that for every $p \in M$ there is a chart $(U, (x^1, \dots, x^n))$ centered around p , we are able to pull back the basis of $T_{\phi(p)} \mathbb{R}^n$ to $T_p M$. The basis of $T_{\phi(p)} \mathbb{R}^n$ is given by paths of the form $t \mapsto \phi(p) + te_i$, where e_i is the i -th canonical basis vector of $\mathbb{R}^n$. Writing this basis as $(\partial_{x^1}, \dots, \partial_{x^n})$, we can pull back along ϕ^{-1} to obtain a basis of $T_p M$, defined as

$$\partial_i|_p := \phi^{-1}(\phi(p) + te_i).$$

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This expression acts on a smooth function as above by

$$\partial_i|_p f = \left. \frac{\partial(f \circ \phi^{-1})}{\partial x^i} \right|_{\phi(p)}.$$

Definition 1.13 (Differential). Let $F : M \rightarrow N$ be a smooth map between smooth manifolds. The **differential** of F at $p \in M$ is a linear map

$$dF_p : T_p M \rightarrow T_{F(p)} N$$

given by

$$dF_p([\gamma]) = [F \circ \gamma].$$

where $[\gamma]$ is an equivalence class of curves through p .

Given local charts $(U, (x^1, \dots, x^m))$ around p and $(V, (y^1, \dots, y^n))$ around $F(p)$, the differential can be expressed in local coordinates as

$$dF_p(\partial_i) = \partial_i F^j|_p \hat{\partial}_j|_{F(p)}.$$

with $F^j = y^j \circ F$ and $\hat{\partial}_j$ being a basis vector of $T_{F(p)} N$. We conclude this section with the definition of smooth vector fields.

Definition 1.14 (Vector Fields). Let M be a smooth manifold. A **smooth vector field** is a smooth section

$$V : M \rightarrow TM$$

such that $\pi \circ V = \text{id}_M$ with the natural projection $\pi : TM \rightarrow M$. The space of smooth sections on M is denoted $\mathfrak{X}(M)$.

Once more, we desire a local coordinate expression. If $(U, (x^1, \dots, x^n))$ is a local chart, we can use the basis of $T_p M$ defined above for all $p \in U$ to write

$$X_p = X^i(p) \partial_i|_p$$

where $X^i : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ are the component functions of X . If a collection of vector fields $(X_1, \dots, X_n)$ spans $T_p M$ locally or globally, we call it a **local or global frame**. Directing our attention one last time to curves, we can now define curves whose velocity vectors form a given vector field.

Definition 1.15 (Integral Curves). Let M be a smooth manifold and $V \in \mathfrak{X}(M)$. An **integral curve** of V is a smooth curve $\gamma : I \rightarrow M$ such that

$$\frac{d}{dt} \gamma(t) = V_{\gamma(t)}$$

for all $t \in I$.

We need this notion of walking along the path prescribed by a vector field later for Hamiltonian phase flows. In general, a flow is the rigorous version of this intuitive idea of following a field:

Note that vector fields also act naturally on smooth functions $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ by means of partial derivation:

$$(Xf)(p) = X_p f = X^i(p) \partial_i|_p(f).$$

Intuitively, one should think of $t \in \mathbb{R}$ as time. A global flow then shifts the whole manifold along some vector field, e.g. the torus rotates under the global flow of a radial vector field.

Definition 1.16 (Flow). Suppose M is a smooth manifold with $V \in \mathfrak{X}(M)$ such that a unique global integral curve of V exists for all $p \in M$. Denoting the integral curve at p by $\gamma_p : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow M$, a **global flow** is a continuous action of $\mathbb{R}$ on M :

$$\begin{aligned}\theta : M \times \mathbb{R} &\rightarrow M \\ (p, t) &\mapsto \gamma_p(t).\end{aligned}$$

Riemannian Metrics

To measure distances and angles, we need additional structure on our smooth manifolds. Dual to the tangent bundle of M , we introduce the **cotangent bundle**

$$T^*M := \coprod_{p \in M} (T_p M)^*$$

which is, as usual in linear algebra, given by the space of linear forms

$$\omega : TM \rightarrow \mathbb{R}.$$

The basis dual to $(\partial_1, \dots, \partial_n)$ will be denoted $(dx^1, \dots, dx^n)$.

Definition 1.17 (Riemannian Manifolds). A **Riemannian metric** on a smooth manifold M is a smooth, symmetric and positive-definite bilinear form

$$g : TM \times TM \rightarrow \mathbb{R}.$$

The pair (M, g) is called **Riemannian manifold**.

This also yields the usual notions obtained with a scalar product on $\mathbb{R}^n$: We have a norm on each $T_p M$ defined by

$$\|v\|_g := \sqrt{\langle v, v \rangle}$$

and an angle given by

$$\cos \angle(v, w) := \frac{\langle v, w \rangle}{\|v\|_g \|w\|_g} \in [0, \pi].$$

Since each g_p is non-degenerate, we even have the well-known musical isomorphisms $T_p M \cong T_p^* M$. If $X = X^i \partial_i$ is a vector field, we identify it with $X^\flat = g_{ij} X^i dx^j$. A covector field $\omega = \omega_i dx^i$ is identified with $\omega^\sharp = g^{ij} \omega_j \partial_i$ where $g^{ij} = g_{ij}^{-1}$.

In local coordinates at some $p \in M$, we can use the canonical basis of $T_p M$ to write $g_p : T_p M \times T_p M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ as

$$g_p(v, w) = g_p(v^i \partial_i|_p, w^j \partial_j|_p) =: \langle v^i \partial_i|_p, w^j \partial_j|_p \rangle = v^i w^j g_{ij}$$

where $g_{ij} = g_p(\partial_i|_p, \partial_j|_p)$ denotes the matrix representation of the metric g . The most important definition arising from the existence of a metric function is in our case the arc length.

Definition 1.18 (Length). Let (M, g) be a smooth Riemannian manifold and $\gamma : I \rightarrow M$ be a smooth curve. The **length** of γ is given by the functional

$$L[\gamma] := \int_I \|\partial_t \gamma(t)\|_g dt..$$

We will now connect those concepts with physics' formalism.

1.3 Lagrangian Mechanics

Calculus of Variations

The central concept is concerned with a special function, the *Lagrangian*. While its definition may seem abstract and purely mathematical, it will turn

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out to be central to a formulation of classical physics on par with Newton's axioms.

Definition 1.19 (Lagrangian). Let M be a smooth manifold with tangent bundle TM . A **Lagrangian** is a smooth function

$$\mathcal{L} : TM \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}.$$

If $\mathcal{L}$ is constant in the second argument, we call it **autonomous**.

A priori, we do not impose any given form on $\mathcal{L}$. If we choose local coordinates $\Phi = (x^1, \dots, x^n, \partial_1, \dots, \partial_n)$, the Lagrangian can be expressed as

$$\mathcal{L}(x^1, \dots, x^n, \partial_1, \dots, \partial_n, t) := \mathcal{L} \circ \Phi^{-1} : \mathbb{R}^{2n} \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}.$$

Bridging between smooth manifolds and physical systems is the concept of configuration manifolds and (velocity) phase spaces as well as the theorem of Euler-Lagrange.

Definition 1.20 (Configuration Manifold). The **configuration manifold** Q of a system of N point masses consists of all possible positions of those N masses in Euclidean 3-space. We call $\dim Q$ the **degrees of freedom**.

To be consistent with notational conventions in physics, we will choose the letter q for coordinates on configuration manifolds. Hence, local coordinates are now given as $\phi = (q^1, \dots, q^n)$.

With this definition, which will suffice for the systems considered later, all configuration manifolds are some subsets of $\mathbb{R}^{3N}$. However, we aim at describing configuration manifolds more precisely than that.

Example 1.21. • The configuration manifold of N free point masses in Euclidean 3-space is given by $\mathbb{R}^{3N}$ as each particle is free to move in three spacial directions independently.

- The two-dimensional double pendulum has the configuration manifold $Q = \mathbb{S}^1 \times \mathbb{S}^1$ as each point can move in one copy of $\mathbb{S}^1$. Note that $\mathbb{S}^1 \times \mathbb{S}^1 \cong T$, so we can think of Q as a 2-torus.
- A rigid rod in Euclidean 2-space is free to rotate around an axis at its end. The configuration manifold is $Q = \mathbb{R}^2 \times \mathbb{S}^1$ since we need two coordinates (q^1, q^2) to describe the position of the axis of rotation and one angle $q^3 \in [0, 2\pi]$ to describe the rotation itself.

From classical physics we know very well that positions are not sufficient to characterize a system fully, one also needs velocities.

Definition 1.22 (Velocity Phase Space). Let Q be the configuration manifold of a physical system. The **velocity phase space** of Q is the tangent bundle TQ .

To give a quick overview: We have $\dim TQ = 2 \cdot \dim Q$, so we need twice as much coordinates on TQ . Those are given by the n positions $(q^1, \dots, q^n)$ of our system at some time t together with the n velocities $(\dot{q}_1, \dots, \dot{q}_n)$ at the same time.

We also have to specify what we are looking for. In physics, one is interested in an *equation of motion* for the considered system. To this end, a **motion** is a smooth curve

$$\gamma : I \subseteq \mathbb{R} \rightarrow Q.$$

We think about I as a time interval, so γ specifies one evolution of the system Q . The one evolution γ actually taken by the system is what we call our *equation of motion*. To obtain such γ , we have to rely on one empirical axiom.

We do not define what a Lagrangian system is, since this is quite difficult to answer. To our knowledge, it is possible to conjure some Lagrangian yielding equations of motion. However, this is anything but straightforward outside of classical mechanics.

Axiom 1.23 (Hamilton's Principle of Extremal Action). Let Q be a configuration space of a Lagrangian physical system with tangent bundle TQ and Lagrangian $\mathcal{L}$. If and only if a given smooth curve $\gamma : I \rightarrow Q$ is an extremal of the **action functional**

$$S[\mathcal{L}] := \int_I \mathcal{L}(\gamma(t), \dot{\gamma}(t), t) dt,$$

it is a motion of Q .

Using this axiom directly to calculate γ from a given Lagrangian is quite cumbersome. The following theorem simplifies this procedure a bit.

Note that while we want to apply this in a physical context, those equations are much more general since we only demand of $\mathcal{L}$ to be smooth. A famous other example of these equations is finding minimal surfaces, found in nature as the thin films soapy water forms on geometrical shapes. To make matters more confusing, one can use these equations to minimize the length functional of the previous section, in which case we call the equations **Euler equations** or, especially if expressed in local coordinates, **Geodesic equations**.

Theorem 1.24 (Euler-Lagrange). Let Q be a smooth manifold and $\mathcal{L}$ be a Lagrangian on $TQ \times \mathbb{R}$. A smooth curve $\gamma : I \rightarrow Q$ extremizes the action functional $S[\gamma]$ if and only if the following set of equations is satisfied for all $t \in I$:

$$\frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}^i} \right) - \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \gamma^i} = 0 \quad (1.2)$$

where γ_i are the components of γ in some local chart *spanning* TM . These differential equations are called **Lagrange Equations of the second kind**.

Since our treatment of the novel physical system relies on this theorem, we want to prove it. We are, however, using a lemma without a proof.

Lemma 1.25 (Fundamental Lemma of Variational Calculus). Let $f : (a, b) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be continuous. If

$$\int_a^b f(t) \nu(t) dt = 0$$

is satisfied for all smooth functions $\nu : (a, b) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ with compact support, then $f \equiv 0$.

Proof. Since we work with a locally trivializing chart of TQ (meaning the coordinates are a full orthogonal system), the equation $\delta S[\mathcal{L}] = 0$ has to hold for each component γ^i . Hence, all components γ^i have to satisfy this equation separately, reducing the problem to one dimension. Therefore, take a path $\gamma : (t_0, t_1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ (we read γ directly in local coordinates). A variation of γ with fixed endpoints is a smooth function

$$\delta\gamma : (t_0, t_1) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

with $\delta\gamma(t_0) = \delta\gamma(t_1) = 0$. If S has an extremum at γ , the functional

derivative vanishes for γ . Using this, we calculate:

$$\begin{aligned} 0 = \delta S[\gamma] &= \frac{d}{d\epsilon} \bigg|_{\epsilon=0} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \mathcal{L}(\gamma + \epsilon \cdot \delta\gamma, \dot{\gamma} + \epsilon \cdot \delta\dot{\gamma}, t) dt \\ &= \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \left\{ \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \gamma} \cdot \delta\gamma + \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}} \cdot \frac{\partial \delta\gamma}{\partial t} + \frac{d\mathcal{L}}{dt} \right\} dt \end{aligned}$$

Concentrating on the second term, we can integrate by parts:

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}} \cdot \frac{\partial \delta\gamma}{\partial t} dt &= \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}} \cdot \delta\gamma \bigg|_{t_0}^{t_1} - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \frac{d}{dt} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}} \cdot \delta\gamma dt \\ &= - \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}} \cdot \delta\gamma dt. \end{aligned}$$

The first term vanished as $\delta\gamma$ is a variation with fixed endpoints. Plugging this back in yields

$$0 = \int_{t_0}^{t_1} \left\{ \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \gamma} - \frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}} \right) \right\} \delta\gamma dt.$$

Since $\delta\gamma$ is compactly supported by definition, we apply the fundamental theorem of calculus to obtain our claim.

For the other direction, the proof can practically be read backwards. $\square$

Physical Lagrangians and Constraints

After accepting that nature seems to follow a universal extremal principle, we want to explore the different important forms a Lagrangian can take. The easiest examples are such that $\mathcal{L}$ is connected with potential and kinetic energy.

Definition 1.26 (Kinetic and Potential Energy). Let TQ be the velocity phase space of a physical system Q . The **kinetic energy** is a quadratic form given locally at $q \in Q$ by

$$\begin{aligned} T : T_q Q \times \mathbb{R} &\rightarrow \mathbb{R} \\ \dot{q} &\mapsto \frac{\|\dot{q}\|^2}{2} \end{aligned}$$

and the **potential energy** is some smooth function

$$U : Q \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}.$$

If the system is autonomous, T and U are independent of the second argument.

Unless specified otherwise, we use the Euclidean metric for $\mathbb{R}^{3N}$. This means that every submanifold Q is endowed with the restricted Euclidean metric, hence kinetic energy is well-defined.

Definition 1.27 (Natural System). A Lagrangian physical system Q is called **natural** if the Lagrangian is given by

$$\mathcal{L}(q, \dot{q}, t) := T(q, \dot{q}, t) - U(q, t)$$

where $T : TQ \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a kinetic energy and $U : Q \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is a potential.

Again, there are autonomous and non-autonomous natural systems. All systems we consider will be autonomous, so T and U only depend on t indirectly through the time dependence of a path $(\gamma, \dot{\gamma})$.

If one is not satisfied with this explanation, one can be more physical: Imagine some curve a free particle in a plane can take. Now imagine a constant as a force acting in one coordinate direction q^1 of the local chart (q^1, q^2) . If we consider this potential to go to infinity, the particle is forced to move in direction q^2 in the limit. It is possible to prove the following proposition by making this idea rigorous.

Note that in the examples above, many systems are constrained to move on some m -dimensional submanifold Q of $\mathbb{R}^{3N}$. We call such constraints **holonomic** if Q is given by $3N - m$ independent equations of the type

$$f_k(q^1, \dots, q^{3N}, t) = 0$$

with $1 \leq k \leq 3N - m$, $(q^1, \dots, q^{3N})$ being global coordinates of $\mathbb{R}^{3N}$ and f being some smooth function in those coordinates. If f_k is independent of t , we call it **scleronomous**, else it is called **rheonomous**.

Theorem 1.28 (Holonomic Systems). A physical system with purely holonomic constraints is natural.

Example 1.29. A free particle with mass m in $\mathbb{R}^3$ has the kinetic energy

$$T(\dot{q}^1, \dot{q}^2, \dot{q}^3) = \frac{m}{2} \delta^{ij} \dot{q}_i \dot{q}_j.$$

Its Lagrangian is just $\mathcal{L} = T$. The Lagrange equations of the second kind read as

$$0 = \frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{\partial T}{\partial \dot{\gamma}^i} \right) = m \ddot{\gamma}^i.$$

Given a set of initial conditions $\gamma^i(t_0) = A_i$ and $\dot{\gamma}^i(t_0) = B_i$, we obtain the motion

$$\gamma^i(t) = A_i t + B_i.$$

Conservation Laws

One huge advantage over the Newtonian formalism is that the Lagrangian directly provides means to connect symmetries of a given system with conservation laws which aid massively in solving for the equations of motion.

Definition 1.30 (Symmetry). Let Q be a configuration manifold with Lagrangian $\mathcal{L}$. We say that Q admits a **symmetry** if there is a one-parameter group of diffeomorphisms

$$\Phi : Q \times \mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow M$$

such that

$$\mathcal{L}(d\varphi^s(\mathbf{q}, \dot{\mathbf{q}}, t)) = \mathcal{L}(\mathbf{q}, \dot{\mathbf{q}}, t)$$

for all $s \in \mathbb{R}$, where we write $\varphi^s(\mathbf{q}, t) := \Phi(\mathbf{q}, t, s)$.

Example 1.31. The most common examples of symmetries are spacial translation

$$\varphi^s(q^1, \dots, q^i, \dots, q^n, t) = (q^1, \dots, q^i + s, \dots, q^n, t)$$

and temporal translation

$$\varphi^s(\mathbf{q}, t) = (\mathbf{q}, t + s).$$

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The celebrated theorem of Emmy Noether will connect symmetries to so-called first integrals. If we have a system of ordinary differential equations

$$f(x(t), \dot{x}(t), t) = 0$$

with solutions $x : I \subseteq \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$, a **first integral** of this equation is a smooth function $\mathcal{I} : \mathbb{R}^n \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that

$$\frac{d}{dt} \mathcal{I}(x(t), t) = 0$$

for any solution x . This means that first integrals are constant along solutions of Lagrangian equations. Their importance arises from the fact that a first integral can always be integrated to reduce the number of unknowns by 1.

Theorem 1.32 (Noether). If the Lagrangian system $(Q, \mathcal{L})$ admits a symmetry Φ , then the Lagrangian equations have a first integral

$$\mathcal{I} : TM \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$$

given in local coordinates by

$$\mathcal{I}(\mathbf{q}, \dot{\mathbf{q}}, t) = \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\mathbf{q}}} \frac{d\Phi(\mathbf{q})}{ds} \Big|_{s=0}.$$

Example 1.33. We consider the case of translational invariance along some axis. Take N point masses m_i in $\mathbb{R}^3$ with N constraints $f_j(\mathbf{q}_j) = 0$ and a potential $U = U(\mathbf{q})$ which admits translation in q_j^1 -direction. The Lagrangian is given by

$$\mathcal{L} = \sum_i \frac{m_i}{2} \delta^{jk} \dot{q}_{ij} \dot{q}_{ik} + U(\mathbf{q}).$$

The symmetry is given by

$$\varphi^s : q_{i1} \mapsto q_{i1} + s.$$

The first integral is

$$\mathcal{I} = \sum_i m_i \dot{q}_{i1} = \sum_i p_{i1}$$

where p_{i1} is the mechanical momentum of the i -th particle in direction of q^1 . This shows that translational symmetry corresponds to conservation of linear, mechanical momentum.

Non-holonomic Systems

We want to conclude the section on Lagrangian systems with a short treatment of the case of non-holonomic constraints. Looking back at our system with $3N - m$ degrees of freedom, we use the m holonomic constraints $f_k(\mathbf{q}, t) = 0$ to eliminate m coordinates by integration. This yields the orthogonal trivialization of TQ which we needed to justify that the coordinate components in the Euler-Lagrange equation vanish independently of each other. Now, we are confronted with m non-holonomic constraints

$$g_k(\mathbf{q}, \dot{\mathbf{q}}, \ddot{\mathbf{q}}, \dots, t) = 0$$

which employ a dependence of the coordinates on one another without being integrable. We will not be able to solve this problem in general, but there are noteworthy special cases.

If we assume that the constraints are still holonomic but we did not integrate them and therefore still have $\dim Q$ coordinates and m first integrals, we can use Lagrange multipliers to save our principle of extremal action.

This notion of a force of constraint fits nicely with our earlier intuitive explanation that constraints can be considered as very strong force fields.

Theorem 1.34 (Lagrangian Multipliers). Let $(Q, \mathcal{L})$ be a Lagrangian system with m holonomic constraints $f(\mathbf{q}, t) = 0$. In this case, a smooth path $\gamma : I \rightarrow Q$ is an extremal of S if and only if the **Lagrange Equations of the First Kind**

$$\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \gamma^i} - \frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{\gamma}^i} \right) + \sum_{k=1}^m \lambda_k(t) \frac{\partial f_k}{\partial \gamma^i} = 0$$

are satisfied, where the $\lambda_k(t)$ are Lagrangian multipliers. The term

$$Q_i = \sum_{k=1}^m \lambda_k(t) \frac{\partial f_k}{\partial \gamma^i}$$

is called **force of constraint** or **generalized force**.

We can apply this equation for a very specific set of non-holonomic constraints.

Definition 1.35 (Semi-Holonomic Constraint). Let $(Q, \mathcal{L})$ be a Lagrangian system with m constraints of the form

$$\omega_k = a_{ik}(\mathbf{q}, \dot{\mathbf{q}}, t) dq^i + a_{k0}(\mathbf{q}, \dot{\mathbf{q}}, t) dt = 0$$

where $1 \leq k \leq m$ and the ω_k are Pfaffian forms. In this case, the constraints are called **semi-holonomic**.

Unfortunately, this is not enough to apply the Lagrange equations of the first kind.

Theorem 1.36 (Integrable Semi-Holonomic Constraints). A Lagrangian system $(Q, \mathcal{L})$ with a semi-holonomic constraint ω is equivalent to a holonomic system if and only if there is an integrating factor $\lambda \neq 0$ and a one-form η such that

$$\lambda \cdot \omega + f \cdot \eta = df,$$

where f is the holonomic constraint and df is the exterior derivative of f .

Example 1.37. A simple example is a hoop rolling down a two-dimensional incline of height h and angle α without slipping. The obvious choice of generalized coordinates are the distance from the starting point and the rotational angle of the hoop, so our first guess at the configuration manifold

1.4. LIE GROUPS AND LIE ALGEBRAS

is $\mathbb{R} \times \mathbb{S}^1$. The kinetic energy is the sum of rotational and translational energy

$$T = \frac{m}{2}(\|\dot{q}\|^2 + R^2\|\dot{\theta}\|^2)$$

and the potential is dependent on the height, hence also on q :

$$U = (h - q \sin \alpha)mg.$$

The rolling condition reads as

$$\dot{q} - R\dot{\theta} = 0$$

which is equivalent to the Pfaffian form

$$0 = dq - R d\theta$$

and hence semi-holonomic. One can immediately see that this is integrable, but for the sake of demonstration, we use one Lagrangian multiplier. The modified Lagrangian is

$$\mathcal{L}(q, \theta, t, \lambda) = \frac{m}{2}(\|\dot{q}\|^2 + R^2\|\dot{\theta}\|^2) + (q \sin \alpha - h)mg + \lambda(\dot{q} - R\dot{\theta})$$

and the Lagrange equations of the second kind yield

$$m\ddot{q} - mg \sin \alpha + \lambda = 0$$

and

$$mR^2\ddot{\theta} - \lambda R = 0.$$

Together with our equation of constraint $R\ddot{\theta} = \ddot{q}$, we obtain the following family of solutions

$$\begin{cases} \ddot{q} = \frac{g \sin \alpha}{2} \\ \ddot{\theta} = \frac{g \sin \alpha}{2R} \\ \lambda = \frac{mg \sin \alpha}{2} \end{cases}.$$

1.4 Lie Groups and Lie Algebras

The preceding chapters dealt with the category of groups and the category of smooth manifolds, respectively. Those two categories can be combined to form a new category which will turn out to be important for the rotational configuration space of a rigid body. After a gentle introduction, we continue by treating the Lie group most important to us: $SO(3)$.

Definition 1.38 (Lie Group). A **smooth Lie group** is a triple $(M, \circ, \mathfrak{A})$ such that $(M, \circ)$ is a group, $(M, \mathfrak{A})$ is a smooth manifold with atlas $\mathfrak{A}$, and

$$(g, h) \mapsto g \circ h$$

as well as

$$g \mapsto g^{-1}$$

are smooth maps.

Example 1.39. The most important examples to physicists are certainly matrix Lie groups. We already mentioned the real *general linear group* $GL_n(\mathbb{R})$, which is also a Lie group. So are the (Lie) subgroups $SO(n)$ and $O(n)$. It is expected that groups of linear maps have smooth multiplication and inversion as linear maps are smooth in general. However, this can only be made rigorous by topologizing GL_n with the metric topology of $\mathbb{R}^{n^2}$ element-wise. All mentioned subgroups then inherit the subspace topology, yielding a Lie group structure.

The main reason for the importance of Lie groups is their connection to symmetry. To understand this, we let some Lie group G act on another smooth manifold M . Expanding our definition of action, we call such an action

$$\rho : G \times M \rightarrow M$$

smooth if for all $g \in G$ and $x \in M$, the map

$$\rho_g : M \rightarrow M, x \mapsto \rho_g(x) = g.x$$

is a smooth map between manifolds.

Our notion of symmetry arises from this definition, but we keep it somewhat informal. A **symmetry** of a manifold M with some structure is the action of some Lie group on M preserving the structure.

Example 1.40. One of the most striking examples of the importance of Lie groups is the fact that different flavours of geometry arise from Lie group actions. Consider the Euclidean space $\mathbb{R}^n$ as Lie Group: Obviously, it is a smooth manifold by definition, it just remains to choose addition as group operation to obtain a Lie group. Then, the **Euclidean group**

$$E(n) := \mathbb{R}^n \rtimes O(n)$$

acts on $\mathbb{R}^n$ by

$$\rho_{\tau, A}(v) := \tau + A(v)$$

where $\tau, v \in \mathbb{R}^n$ and $A \in O(n)$. The multiplication inside $E(n)$ is given by the usual semidirect product multiplication:

$$(\tau, A) \circ (\tau', A') = (\tau + A(\tau'), AA').$$

This action is at the core of Euclidean geometry, meaning that Euclidean geometry studies objects invariant under the action of $E(n)$. If one replaces $O(n)$ for example by the whole of GL_n , we arrive at affine geometry. More physically motivated examples would be the action of the Lorentz group on Minkowski space-time (modeled as $\mathbb{R}^4$ with the Minkowski metric) or the action of the symplectic group on symplectic manifolds, which govern Hamiltonian mechanics.

With this idea in mind, we take a look at representations again. Of special interest are so-called *faithful* representations $\varrho : G \rightarrow GL_n$ of some Lie group G which are *injective*.

Example 1.41. We continue with the study of $E(n)$.

Luckily, matrix Lie groups are already subgroups of GL_n , so we can just take

One example for such a structure would, of course, be a metric. If an action ρ preserves a metric g on M , we can write this explicitly as

$$g(\rho_h(x), \rho_h(y)) = g(h.x, h.y) = g(x, y)$$

for all $h \in G$ and $x, y \in M$.

This semidirect product group may seem confusing at first, but this case can be made very intuitive by thinking about a physical system in $\mathbb{R}^n$ with fixed time (for now) and considering only $SO(n) \leq O(n)$. Then, the action of $\mathbb{R}^n \rtimes SO(n)$ first rotates v by the rotation matrix R and then translates the rotated frame by τ . This also demonstrates why the interior group multiplication has to have this particular form: If one applies first a rotation R' and then a translation τ' , followed by the same procedure with (R, τ) , the second rotation R has to be done from the perspective of the rotated frame, so we rotate τ' by R before adding the second translation τ . Considering $E(n)$ again, we allow all transformations preserving orthogonality (e.g. reflection), but the same idea applies.

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the inclusion as representation. The representation of $E(n)$ needs to take care of one additional translation, which is not represented by $GL(n)$. We obtain a map $\varrho : E(n) \rightarrow GL_n$ which sends $(\tau, A) \in E(n)$ to

$$\varrho(\tau, A) := \begin{pmatrix} A & b \\ 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \in GL(n+1, \mathbb{R}).$$

Lie groups do not only interact well with manifolds, but are also interesting by themselves. We want to shortly explore the tangent space of a Lie group. Since every Lie group has a smooth multiplication, we always have an action

$$L_h : G \times G \rightarrow G, g \mapsto L_h(g) = h \circ g$$

for some fixed $h \in G$. This is called **left translation**. It gives rise to a map

$$(dL_h)_g : T_g G \rightarrow T_g G$$

via the usual differential. Now, we consider smooth vector fields on our Lie group and give them more structure.

Definition 1.42 (Lie Bracket). Let M be a smooth manifold and $X, Y \in \mathfrak{X}(M)$. The **Lie bracket** is an operator

$$[\cdot, \cdot] : \mathcal{C}^\infty(M) \rightarrow \mathcal{C}^\infty(M),$$

mapping a smooth function $f : M \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ to another smooth function defined by

$$[X, Y]f = XY(f) - YX(f).$$

Note that the Lie bracket itself can be defined for arbitrary smooth manifolds, not only Lie groups. Also, we have an expression in local coordinates as

$$[X, Y] = (X^i \partial_i Y^j - Y^i \partial_i X^j) \partial_j.$$

We can directly see that for left invariant vector fields X, Y , the Lie bracket is also left invariant. Hence, the vector space of left invariant vector spaces is closed under one additional operation. This hints at another structure we already touched upon.

Definition 1.43 (Lie Algebra). A **Lie Algebra** over $\mathbb{R}$ is an algebra $(\mathfrak{g}, [\cdot, \cdot])$ such that two additional identities hold:

- Antisymmetry: $[X, Y] = -[Y, X]$
- Jacobi Identity: $[X, [Y, Z]] + [Y, [Z, X]] + [Z, [X, Y]] = 0$.

Example 1.44. The most important example is the one we just constructed. Given a Lie group G , the space of smooth, left invariant vector fields on L , denoted $\mathfrak{g}$, is a Lie algebra with the Lie bracket. Separated from Lie groups, one can consider smooth vector fields on a smooth manifold in general. Another example of a Lie algebra is $\mathbb{R}^3$ together with the vector cross product, which we already encountered and will encounter again.

Now, we conclude the general discussion with a theorem, yielding fundamental insight into the relationship of a Lie group and its associated algebra.

Theorem 1.45 (Lie Group-Algebra Correspondence). Let G be a Lie group with identity $\text{id} \in G$ and let $\mathfrak{g}$ be the Lie algebra of left-invariant vector fields on G . Then the evaluation

$$\mathfrak{g} \ni X \mapsto X|_{\text{id}} \in T_{\text{id}}G$$

of a left-invariant vector field at the identity is a vector space isomorphism $T_{\text{id}}G \cong \mathfrak{g}$.

This means that the best linear approximation of a Lie group at the identity is its Lie algebra. In lieu of group theory, one calls Lie algebras linearized Lie groups.

Example 1.46. Bridging to our discussion of $\text{SO}(3)$, we demonstrate how to calculate the Lie algebra $\mathfrak{so}(3)$. By the preceding theorem, the Lie algebra is isomorphic to a tangent vector at the identity matrix $\text{id} \in \text{SO}(3)$. Hence, choose a smooth path

$$\mathbb{R} \ni t \mapsto A(t) \in \text{SO}(3)$$

with $A(0) = \text{id}$. We can expand up to first order as

$$A(t) = \text{id} + B(t)t + \mathcal{O}(t^2).$$

1.5 Ordinary Differential Equations

This section is just meant to quickly list the differential equations we will encounter later and give methods to solve them. In this, and only in this, chapter we will do separation of variables in ODEs by seemingly separating differentials of the form $\frac{dx}{dt}$.

Autonomous ODE

Definition 1.47 (Second-Order Autonomous ODE). A **second-order autonomous first-order ODE** is of the form

$$\ddot{x}(t) = f(x, \dot{x}) \tag{1.3}$$

where $x : \Omega \subseteq \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is at least twice differentiable and $f : \Omega \times \mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is continuous.

We consider the special case where $f(x, \dot{x}) = f(x)$. The substitution $y := \frac{dx}{dt}$ yields

$$\int y \, dy = \int f(x) \, dx \implies v = \pm \sqrt{2 \int f(x) \, dx + C_1}$$

where $C_1 \in \mathbb{R}$ is some constant of integration. Plugging back yields the implicit solution set

$$\pm \int \frac{dx}{\sqrt{2 \int f(x) \, dx + C_1}} = t + C_2 \tag{1.4}$$

with a second constant $C_2 \in \mathbb{R}$.

CHAPTER TWO

Magnetic Ball on an Incline

2.1 Two-Dimensional System

Lagrangian Equation of Motion

We start our investigation by considering a very simplified model of a rigid two-dimensional disk of mass M with a constant magnetic moment $\mathbf{m}$ rolling on an inclined plane of length l and angle α without slipping in the earth magnetic field $\mathbf{B}$. The moment of inertia is $I = \frac{MR^2}{2}$. Similar to the example of semi-holonomic constraints, our generalized coordinates are the rolling distance q and the rotational angle θ . Note that while $\mathbf{m}$ is constant in the rolling frame of the disk, the angle between $\mathbf{m}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ changes with the rolling motion. We have again the same semi-holonomic constraint

$$dq - R d\theta = 0.$$

This is a first integral, yielding

$$q(t) - q_0 = R\theta(t) - \theta_0$$

where we set $q_0 := q(0)$ and $\theta_0 := \theta(0)$. For simplicity, we choose the coordinates in such a way that w.l.o.g. $q_0 = 0 = \theta_0$. The kinetic energy is given by

$$T(q, \dot{q}) = \frac{M}{2} \|\dot{q}\|^2 + \frac{I}{2} \|\dot{\theta}\|^2 = \frac{3M}{4} \dot{q}^2$$

where we substituted $\theta = \frac{q}{R}$. Two potentials act on the disk, the first being gravity

$$U_g(q) = Mgh = (q - l)Mg \sin \alpha.$$

The second is due to the magnetic moment of the disk interacting with the earth's magnetic field. Assuming an ideal magnetic dipole interaction, the potential is governed by the angle between $\mathbf{m}$ and $\mathbf{B}$. Assuming an initial angle of β at $t = 0$, the angle at time t is simply $\beta - \theta$. Therefore, the electromagnetic potential is

$$U_{em}(q) = -\langle \mathbf{m}, \mathbf{B} \rangle = -mB \cos \left(\beta - \frac{q}{R} \right)$$

with $m = \|\mathbf{m}\|$ and $B = \|\mathbf{B}\|$.

We obtain the Lagrangian

$$\mathcal{L}(q, \dot{q}) = T - U_g - U_{em} = \frac{3M}{4} \|\dot{q}(t)\|^2 + (l - q(t))Mg \sin \alpha + mB \cos \left(\beta - \frac{q(t)}{R} \right)$$

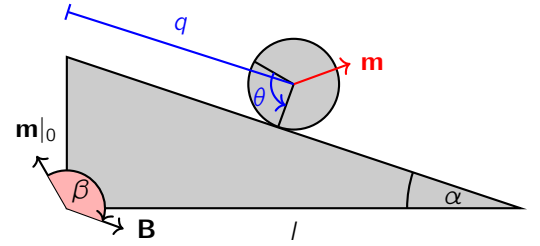


Figure 2.1: A sketch of the considered system. The vector $m|_0$ denotes the magnetic moment at $t = 0$. One can see that the angle between $\mathbf{m}$ and $\mathbf{B}$ at any point in time is the difference between β and θ . Since $\cos$ is symmetric on $\mathbb{R}$, the change of sign as $\mathbf{m}$ passes $\mathbf{B}$ is not of concern.

Allowing β to be arbitrary is probably not necessary for the practical experiment as the dipole will align itself with the outer field if one does not impair this movement until the disk starts rolling.

which gives rise to just one Lagrangian equation of the second kind:

$$\frac{d}{dt} \left(\frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial \dot{q}} \right) - \frac{\partial \mathcal{L}}{\partial q} = 0 \quad (2.1)$$

This yields the ODE

$$\ddot{q}(t) = \frac{2g}{3} \sin \alpha + \frac{2mB}{3MR} \sin \left(\beta - \frac{q}{R} \right) = f(q(t))$$

which is a second-order autonomous ODE. We already discussed how to solve such an equation. The first integral needed is

$$\begin{aligned} \int_{q_0=0}^q f(\tau) d\tau &= \int_{q_0=0}^q \left(\frac{2g}{3} \sin \alpha + \frac{2mB}{3MR} \sin \left(\beta - \frac{q}{R} \right) \right) d\tau \\ &= \frac{2g}{3} \sin(\alpha) q - \frac{2mB}{3M} \left(\cos \left(\beta - \frac{q}{R} \right) - \cos \beta \right) \end{aligned}$$

We make some abbreviations to keep everything readable. Define $A := \frac{4g}{3} \sin \alpha$, $B := -\frac{4mB}{3M}$ and $C := \frac{4mB}{3M} \cos \beta$. The implicit solution is then given by

$$t = \pm \int_0^{q(t)} \frac{1}{\sqrt{Aq - B \cos(\beta - \frac{q}{R}) + C}} dq. \quad (2.2)$$

Unfortunately, this integral has no closed-form solution. The only option is to calculate the integral numerically, for example by means of a Taylor series, and then invert pointwise to obtain $q = q(t)$. We will focus on some aspects which can be derived in limiting cases.

Symmetries

The derived Lagrangian is not very abundant in symmetries. As $\mathcal{L}$ is autonomous, the system admits time translation symmetry and hence conservation of energy. However, this is not very surprising as we did not enforce the rolling condition by means of a dissipative Lagrangian but instead as semi-holonomic integrable constraint. The variable q does appear explicitly in the Lagrangian, so it can not be cyclic. The only non-trivial symmetry remains time symmetry.

Conclusion

While it is quite surprising that such a simple system does not admit a closed-form analytic solution, we gain some first insight in the general usefulness of the Lagrangian formalism to derive equations of motion. However, our hope to solve the more complicated three-dimensional system is very much reduced, especially since the three-dimensional rolling constraint is not always semi-holonomic.

2.2 Magnetic Balls in Earth's Magnetic Field